the special status of the state of Jammu and Kashmir. Its thinking had certainly been influenced by the suggestions made in 1950 by Sir Owen Dixon, gaining Nehru's initial interest, saying that there might be, as part of the plebiscitary process, some kind of partition of the state.

Notwithstanding these grave differences that the regions of Ladakh and Jammu had with Abdullah's regime, on 17 November 1952, Sheikh Abdullah announced the end of the Dogra dynasty. The Maharaja was replaced by a constitutional head of state, the Sadr-e-Riyasat, who was to be elected for a five-year term by the legislative assembly or, in the first instance, in the absence of such an assembly, by the constituent assembly. Karan Singh was elected the first such head of state, and so the Dogra's managed to retain some foothold in the corridors of power of the polity that Gulab Singh had created.

From the perspective of the West, there were no positive aspects to close liaison between the Russians and Abdullah in Kashmir. The hope was that Nehru's tough internal battle with the communists would convert him into a cold warrior. The people at London were unsure whether Abdullah was a communist or merely a political opportunist with left-wing leanings. Abdullah taunted his detractors by pointing that they tarred him with many brushes, primarily the communal and the communist brush. His cabinet had several active communist party-card holding members, the most prominent of them being G. M. Sadiq.[26] The CIA was very concerned about Sadiq's upcoming trip to Moscow in November 1952, which he claimed was for medical reasons. It was rumoured that it was actually a combination trip designed to enable his debriefing by his Soviet handlers.[27] For the US State Department, the only redeeming feature of Abdullah's tactical romance with the Soviets was that it made Nehru retain a strong hold on Abdullah[28] since Nehru would not tolerate any overt Soviet intervention in Kashmir. The CIA, in fact, desired to take advantage of Abdullah's dependence on India. They wanted to use the Ladakh-Tibet trade mission of 1953 to gather intelligence in Sinkiang, which was on the verge of being overrun by the PLA.[29]